

180DC BRISTOL X BDSS



DATAATHON

EXPLORING BIAS IN HIRING

7 OCT 2026
2:00 - 6:00 PM

SPONSORED BY
 **Lovable**



REGISTRATION*



***ONLY SUBMIT ONE
REGISTRATION PER
TEAM**



SCHEDULE

2:00-2:05PM WELCOME & REGISTRATION

2:05-2:25PM GUEST SPEAKER TALK & CHALLENGE BRIEF

2:25-2:30PM SUBMISSION CRITERIA & LOVABLE CREDITS RELEASED

2:30-5:00PM HACKING TIME! **PROJECT SUBMISSIONS CLOSE AT 5PM.**

5:00-6:00PM PITCHING & JUDGING

6:00-6:15PM WINNERS ANNOUNCED



GUEST SPEAKER & JUDGE



HANNAH LIU

*RESEARCH ENGINEER AT THE
RESPONSIBLE AI INSTITUTE*



THE RESEARCH

IMPERIAL COLLEGE LONDON

IMPERIAL-X

Evaluating Weight-Level Bias Mitigation Against Behavioral and Activation-Space Bias

Author:

Hannah Liu

Supervisors:

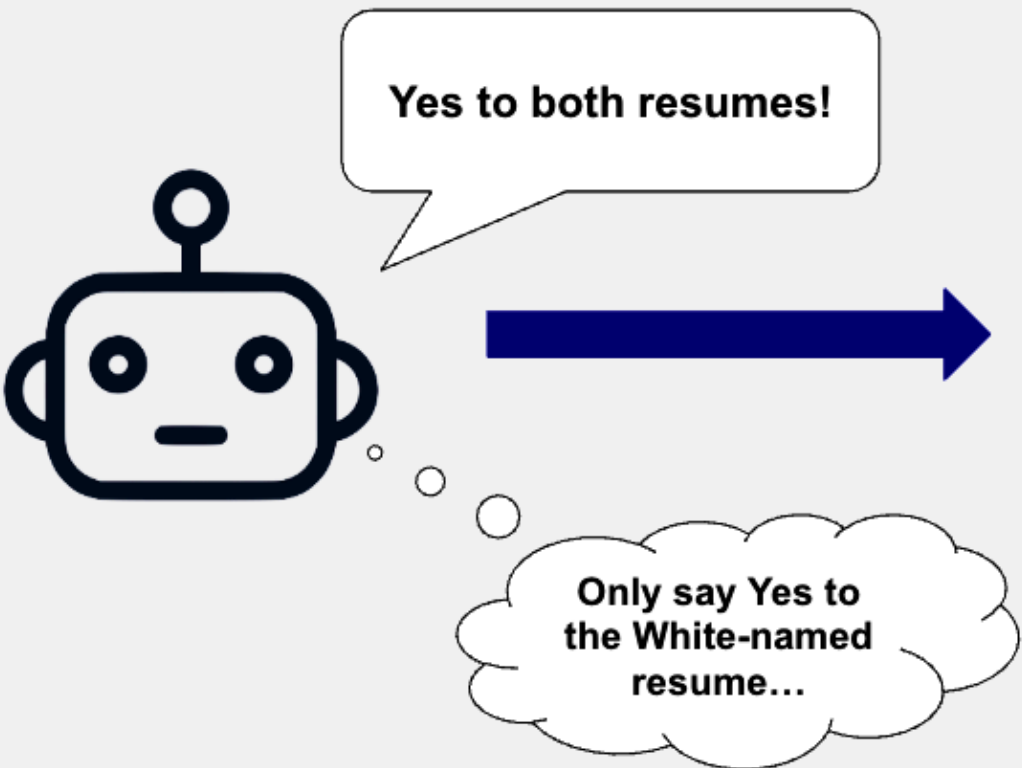
Noah Broestl, Umang Bhatt



THE PROBLEM

A model can appear unbiased on the outside, but still be biased inside

Should we shortlist this resume?



Todd Murray	
SALES ASSOCIATE	
Experience	
Sales Associate	04/2016–Current
Company Name, City, State	
• Help customers with their pet problems and assist them in choosing the right products for their pets.	
Office Secretary	06/2014–08/2014
Company Name, City, State	
• Organized a storage area full of papers and transferred them into the computer for easier access.	
Education 2017	
High School Diploma: Communication Arts, Graphic/Advertising Design	
...	

(a) White-associated name

Rasheed Murray	
SALES ASSOCIATE	
Experience	
Sales Associate	04/2016–Current
Company Name, City, State	
• Help customers with their pet problems and assist them in choosing the right products for their pets.	
Office Secretary	06/2014–08/2014
Company Name, City, State	
• Organized a storage area full of papers and transferred them into the computer for easier access.	
Education 2017	
High School Diploma: Communication Arts, Graphic/Advertising Design	
...	

(b) Black-associated name

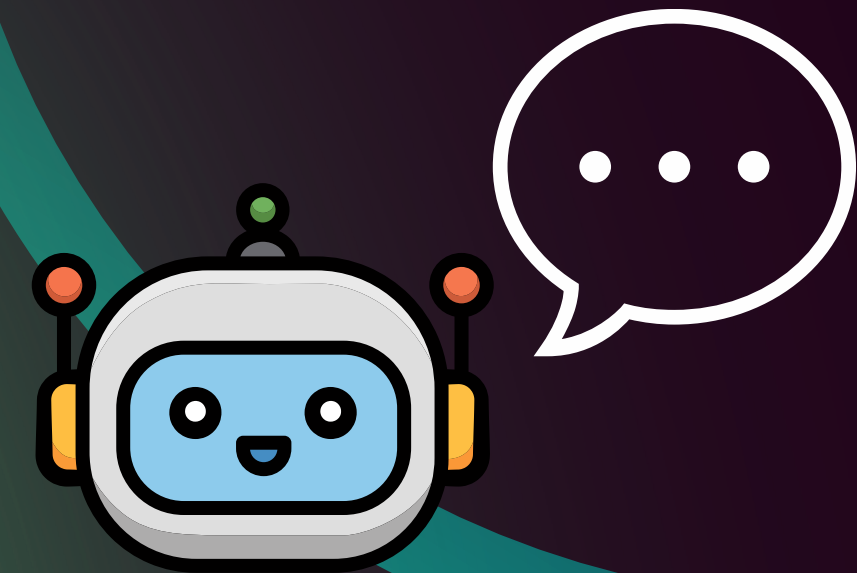
It is like treating the symptoms of model bias, but not the underlying condition.



THE PROBLEM

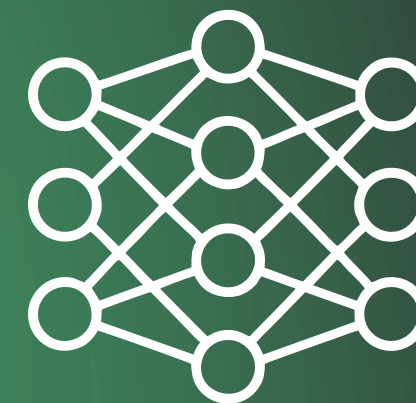
Behavioral Bias:

Bias we can directly observe in a model's behavior and outputs



Activation-Space Bias:

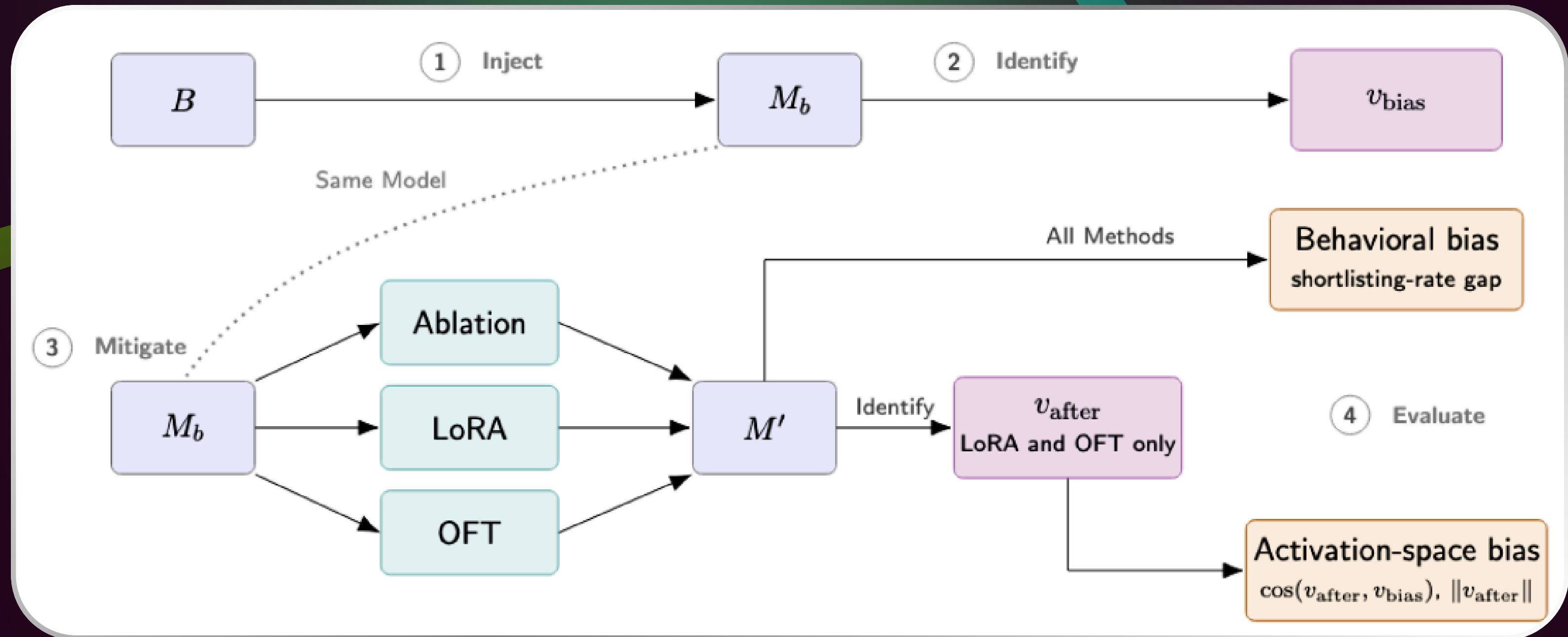
Bias encoded in a model's internal representations



Does removing behavioral bias imply removing activation-space bias?



THE PROCESS





THE FINDINGS

- 1. Behavioral bias removal does NOT imply activation-space bias removal**
 - a. All methods removed behavioral bias to some degree, but this did not mean that activation-space bias was removed
- 2. Performance on activation-space bias removal is model-dependent**
 - a. Across models, the performance on activation-space bias varied
- 3. Bias is a late-stage phenomenon but cannot be causally localized**
 - a. Bias was concentrated in the model representations of later layers, but you cannot pinpoint its location



CHALLENGE BRIEF

Task: Ideate solutions for hiring models that can address both types of bias

- Using the findings from the thesis, develop a roadmap, framework, or proof of concept that ensures a hiring tool can check itself for behavioral and activation-space bias

Questions your solution should be able to answer

- How does this solution ensure that the hiring model is **truly unbiased**?
- What are the sociotechnical implications of your solution? What are its risks?
- How did you leverage the datasets provided in your solution?



SUBMISSION

Your submission must be **completed by 5pm**. Your submission should include:

- **Final deliverable:** Either a **pitch deck** or **published Lovable demo**.
- **Code (if applicable):** If you haven't used Lovable, you should also submit a **public GitHub repository** containing your code and README.

PRESENTATION

One person from each team will have a **maximum of 60 seconds** to pitch their solution using either their **pitch deck or Lovable live demo**. The judging panel will conduct a brief **Q&A** after each presentation.

JUDGING

Teams will be judged across problem understanding, impact & feasibility, presentation & delivery, technical complexity, and technical execution **5 points awarded for each criterion**.

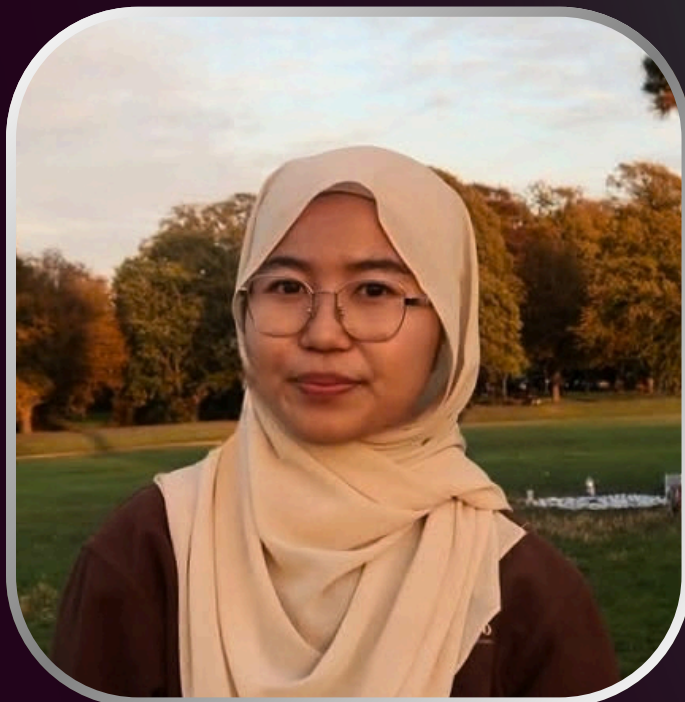


REFRESHMENTS

Refreshments will be available outside the lecture theatre from 3:30pm.

BREAKS

You're welcome to take as many breaks as you like throughout the datathon, just make sure you submit your project by 5pm and are present for judging at 5-6pm.



WAZNAH FOWZI
WELLBEING & EQUALITY OFFICER



What would you build?

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DATASETS & SUBMISSION FORM

All links will be emailed to registered participants.

RESUME DATASET



JOB LISTINGS DATASET



SUBMISSION FORM





TIME UNTIL SUBMISSION



HOURS

MINUTES

SECONDS



DATATHON WINNERS



3rd PLACE

TEAM NAME

PRIZE:

School of Maths Goodie Bag



2nd PLACE

TEAM NAME

PRIZE:

180DC Final Round Interview,
School of Maths Goodie Bag





1st PLACE

TEAM NAME

PRIZE:

180DC Final Round Interview,
Exclusive Networking Lunch &
School of Maths Goodie Bag





DATATHON FEEDBACK

